Guest Wi-Fi for visitors

Article KB0010096 | Owner: Network Support | Subcategory: General | Applies to: Windows 11 laptops, macOS laptops, iOS/Android smartphones, tablets, any device supporting WPA2-Enterprise (802.1X)

Summary

The ACME-Guest wireless network provides temporary internet access for visitors, contractors, and other non-employees while keeping corporate resources isolated. Users connect using sponsored credentials supplied by their host or via self-service registration at the reception kiosk. This article explains how to connect, verify access, and troubleshoot common issues.

Symptoms

- Unable to see the SSID 'ACME-Guest' in the list of available networks
- Connection attempt fails with the message 'Cannot connect to this network'
- After connecting, no internet access or the captive portal does not appear
- Authentication error: 'Invalid username or password'

Common causes

- Visitor credentials have expired or were not sponsored by an employee
- Device missing a valid 802.1X supplicant profile or configured with the wrong authentication method
- MAC address blocked due to a previous policy violation
- Network infrastructure issue such as an access-point outage or RADIUS server unavailability

Overview

ACME-Guest is the sponsored visitor Wi-Fi network. It uses WPA2-Enterprise with machine-certificate authentication for the infrastructure and requires users to present a temporary username/password (or a QR-code token) that is valid for the duration of their visit. Traffic is isolated from the corporate VLANs and only internet access is permitted.

Self-Help Procedure - Connecting to ACME-Guest Wi-Fi

Follow these steps to connect your device to the ACME-Guest network using the credentials provided by your host or obtained at the reception kiosk.

1. 1. Ensure Wi-Fi is enabled on your device and select the SSID **ACME-Guest** from the list of available networks.
2. 2. If prompted, choose **WPA2-Enterprise** or **802.1X** as the security method.
3. 3. Enter the username and password provided by your host or received at the reception kiosk. If you received a QR-code, scan it with your device's camera to auto-fill the credentials.
4. 4. Accept any certificate prompts - the network uses a trusted RADIUS certificate issued by Acme Global.
5. 5. Wait for the connection to establish; you should see a 'Connected' status.
6. 6. Open a web browser and navigate to any external site (e.g., https://www.example.com) to confirm you have internet access.

Verification - Confirming Internet Access

After you believe you are connected, verify that you actually have working internet access.

1. 1. Open a browser and try to load a page you have never visited before (e.g., https://www.bbc.com). If the page loads, you are successfully authenticated.
2. 2. Alternatively, run a ping or nslookup command: `ping 8.8.8.8` should return replies; `nslookup www.google.com` should resolve to an IP address.
3. 3. If you see a captive portal asking for re-authentication, repeat the self-help steps with fresh credentials.
4. 4. Note that internal Acme resources (intranet, file shares, internal sites) will not be reachable - this is expected and confirms the traffic isolation.

Service Desk Procedure - Troubleshooting Guest Wi-Fi Issues

Use this procedure to diagnose and resolve guest Wi-Fi connectivity problems reported by visitors or hosts.

1. 1. Ask the user for the exact time of the attempt, device MAC address (if available), and the error message they saw.

2. 2. Verify that the visitor's sponsorship record is active in the Sponsorship Portal (check expiry time and that the username/password matches).
3. 3. Check the RADIUS authentication logs for the AP that served the user - look for failures such as 'invalid credentials', 'access-reject', or 'no response'.
4. 4. If the logs show no authentication request, confirm the device associated with the correct SSID and that the AP is online (check AP health in the Wireless LAN Controller).
5. 5. For certificate-related issues, validate that the device trusts the RADIUS server certificate; if not, instruct the user to install the Acme Global root CA (available via Company Portal).
6. 6. If multiple users report the same issue, escalate to Network Support for a possible AP or controller outage.

When to escalate

Escalate to the Network Support group when: (a) the RADIUS server returns repeated authentication failures for valid credentials, (b) multiple APs report disconnection or high error rates, or (c) the user cannot connect after verifying sponsorship and device configuration. Include in the ticket: timestamp of failure, device MAC address, SSID (ACME-Guest), exact error message, sponsorship details (username, expiry), and any relevant RADIUS or AP log excerpts.

Keywords: guest wifi, visitor wireless, ACME-Guest, WPA2-Enterprise, 802.1X, sponsored access, captive portal, authentication failure, no internet guest wifi, troubleshoot guest wifi